

O God, My Faithful God

- 1 O God, my faithful God,
true fountain ever flowing,
without whom nothing is,
all perfect gifts bestowing:
give me a healthy frame,
and may I have within
a conscience free from blame,
a soul unstained by sin.
- 2 Give me the strength to do
with ready heart and willing,
whate'er thou dost command,
my calling here fulfilling —
to do it when I ought,
with all my strength, and bless
whatever I have wrought,
for thou must give success.
- 3 Keep me from saying words
that later need recalling;
guard me, lest idle speech
may from my lips be falling:
but when, within my place,
I must and ought to speak,
then to my words give grace,
lest I offend the weak.
- 4 When dangers gather round,
oh, keep me calm and fearless;
help me to bear the cross
when life seems dark and cheerless;
help me, as thou hast taught,
to love both great and small,
and, by thy Spirit's might,
to live at peace with all.

Words: Johann Heermann, 1630; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1858; alt.

Music: Ahasuerus Fritsch, 1679; arr. J. S. Bach

Tune: DARMSTADT · 6.7.6.7.6.6.6.6 · Scripture: 1 Thessalonians 5:24

Public domain.